

# Drift — Prototype Residency

*An 8-week embedded residency to build the working prototype that proves — or breaks — the diagnostic bet.*

F o r e c a s t   ·   R e s i d e n c i e s   ·   8   w e e k s   e m b e d d e d

# Every module runs three tracks at once.

## NARRATIVE

*You stopped debating the roadmap.  
The prototype settled the argument in  
six weeks.*

## COGNITIVE

*Prototypes Garden: structured  
foresight scenarios wired to real data,  
real users, real ROI.*

## IDENTITY

*From meeting-holder to prototype-  
holder.*

## *Why this matters*

Anchor the residency on the diagnostic bet's why.

*"Why did this org bet on this?"*

### **01. Bet Recital**

15 min

*Read the bet aloud.*

Prompt: Kickoff opens by reading the diagnostic bet verbatim.

*Debrief: No commentary. Just witnessed.*

### **02. User Story from the Bet**

90 min

*One user story per beneficiary.*

Prompt: Draft one user story per beneficiary of the bet.

*Debrief: Post to the residency room wall.*

### **03. The Fear Refresh**

150 min

*Re-run stakeholder fears.*

Prompt: Ask 5 stakeholders: 'What are you afraid the prototype will show?'

*Debrief: Compare to diagnostic fear map.*

# *The reframe*

Break the default 'MVP' lens with 'evidence prototype'.

*"What is the smallest thing that would count as evidence?"*

## 01. Evidence Sketch

60 min

*Sketch the evidence before the product.*

Prompt: Draw what a proof-image would look like.  
What screen? What chart? What quote?

Debrief: Ask: 'What's the smallest thing that would move the room?'

## 02. The Fake-Screen Test

240 min

*Test with a fake screenshot.*

Prompt: Show one hand-drawn screen to 5 real users.  
Log reactions.

Debrief: Ask: 'Did the sketch move them more than a real product would have?'

## 03. Wizard-of-Oz Round

180 min

*Fake the backend with a human.*

Prompt: Run one full user interaction with a human in the loop.

Debrief: Log every question the human couldn't answer.

# Organize complexity

Introduce the Prototypes Garden framework.

*"Which garden bed does this prototype belong in?"*

## 01. Garden Bed Assignment

60 min

*Assign to a bed.*

Prompt: Pick: signal-testing, workflow, ontology, business-model, ecosystem. Justify.

Debrief: Ask: *"Which bed did we default to? Was it right?"*

## 02. Bed-Specific Success Criteria

45 min

*Each bed has its own metrics.*

Prompt: Write the 3 success criteria specific to this bed.

Debrief: Circulate. *Signal criteria differ from workflow criteria.*

## 03. Cross-Bed Risk

30 min

*Name the risk of being in this bed.*

Prompt: Every bed has a failure mode. Name yours.

Debrief: Post next to the prototype wall.

# Pattern discovery

Build, test, learn — publicly.

*"What is the prototype telling us that we didn't expect?"*

## 01. The Weekly Demo

45 min

*One 45-min demo every week. Public.*

Prompt: Anyone in the org can attend. Log surprises.

*Debrief: Post the demo recording each week.*

## 02. Failure Log

60 min

*Publish every failure.*

Prompt: Weekly note: what didn't work and why. Public channel.

*Debrief: Ask: 'Which failure taught the most?'*

## 03. The Skeptic's Session

60 min

*Invite the loudest skeptic.*

Prompt: Book a 60-min session with the person most likely to reject the prototype.

*Debrief: Log every objection. Address 3 next week.*

# Commitment

Decide: kill, extend, or productionize.

*"Did the prototype prove or break the bet?"*

## 01. The Verdict Meeting

90 min

*One meeting. One verdict.*

Prompt: 90-min meeting. Verdict: kill / extend / productionize. In writing.

*Debrief: Read the verdict to the team same day.*

## 02. Post-Mortem or Pre-Mortem

180 min

*Write one, no matter the verdict.*

Prompt: Kill → post-mortem. Productionize → pre-mortem for launch.

*Debrief: Both circulated to the org.*

## 03. The Handoff Package

240 min

*Everything needed for the next team.*

Prompt: Bundle: prototype, evidence, verdict, post/pre-mortem, next-30-days plan.

*Debrief: Deliver to next team. Sign off.*

## *How the arc unfolds.*

- |    |                                         |       |                                      |
|----|-----------------------------------------|-------|--------------------------------------|
| 01 | <b>Week 1 — Bet recital</b><br>40h      | Love  | <i>User stories wall built.</i>      |
| 02 | <b>Week 2 — Fake first</b><br>40h       | Magic | <i>Fake-screen tests logged.</i>     |
| 03 | <b>Week 3 — Bed choice</b><br>40h       | Calm  | <i>Bed + criteria + risk posted.</i> |
| 04 | <b>Weeks 4-7 — Public build</b><br>160h | Open  | <i>4 weekly demos + failure log.</i> |
| 05 | <b>Week 8 — Verdict</b><br>40h          | Free  | <i>Verdict + handoff package.</i>    |



## COMMITMENT CONTRACT

*"What is the verdict on the diagnostic bet?"*

The prototype verdict is \_\_\_\_\_. The evidence is \_\_\_\_\_. The next 30 days will \_\_\_\_\_. The receiving team is \_\_\_\_\_.

*Witness — The executive sponsor of the bet.*